

Offense

Occasions of, must arrive.

Matthew 18:7 Woe unto the world because of offences! for it must needs be that offences come; but woe to that man by whom the offence cometh!

Occasions of, forbidden.

1 Corinthians 10:32 Give none offence, neither to the Jews, nor to the Gentiles, nor to the Church of God:

2 Corinthians 6:3 Giving no offence in any thing, that the ministry be not blamed:

Persecution, a cause of, to mere professors.

Matthew 13:21 Yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when Tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, By and by he is offended.

Matthew 24:10 And then shall many be offended, and shall betray one another, and shall hate one another.

Matthew 26:31 Then saith Jesus unto them, All ye shall be offended because of me this night: for it is written, I will smite the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered abroad.

THE WICKED TAKE, AT

The low station of Christ.

Isaiah 53:1-3 Who hath believed our report? and to whom is the arm of the LORD revealed? 2 For he shall grow up before him as a tender plant, and as a root out of a dry ground: he hath no form nor comeliness; and when we shall see him, there is no beauty that we should desire him. 3 He is despised and rejected of men; a man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief: and we hid as it were our faces from him; he was despised, and we esteemed him not.

Matthew 13:54-57 And when he was come into his own country, he taught them in their synagogue, insomuch that they were astonished, and said, Whence hath this man this wisdom, and these mighty works? 55 Is not this the carpenter's son? is not his mother called Mary? and his Brethren, James, and Joses, and Simon, and Judas? 56 And his sisters, are they not all with us? Whence then hath this man all these things? 57 And they were offended in him. But Jesus said unto them, A prophet is not without honour, save in his own country, and in his own house.

Christ, as the corner-stone.

Isaiah 8:14 And he shall be for a sanctuary; but for a stone of stumbling and for a rock of offence to both the houses of Israel, for a gin and for a snare to the inhabitants of Jerusalem.

Romans 9:33 As it is written, Behold, I lay in Sion a stumblingstone and rock of offence: and whosoever believeth on him shall not be ashamed.

1 Peter 2:8 And a stone of stumbling, and a rock of offence, even to them which stumble at the word, being disobedient: whereunto also they were appointed.

Christ, as the bread of life.

John 6:58-61 This is that bread which came down from heaven: not as your Fathers did eat manna, and are Dead: he that eateth of this bread shall live for ever. 59 These things said he in the synagogue, as he taught in Capernaum. 60 Many therefore of his disciples, when they had heard this, said, This is an hard saying; who can hear it? 61 When Jesus knew in himself that his disciples murmured at it, he said unto them, Doth this offend you?

Christ crucified.

1 Corinthians 1:23 But we preach Christ crucified, unto the Jews a stumblingblock, and unto the Greeks foolishness;

Galatians 5:11 And I, Brethren, if I yet preach circumcision, why do I yet suffer persecution? then is the offence of the cross ceased.

The righteousness of Faith.

Romans 9:32 Wherefore? Because they sought it not by Faith, but as it were by the works of The Law. For they stumbled at that stumblingstone;

The necessity of inward purity.

Matthew 15:11-12 Not that which goeth into the mouth defileth a man; but that which cometh out of the mouth, this defileth a man. 12 Then came his disciples, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the Pharisees were offended, after they heard this saying?

Blessedness of not taking, at Christ.

Matthew 11:6 And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me.

Saints warned against taking.

John 16:1 These things have I spoken unto you, that ye should not be offended.

Saints SHOULD

Be without.

Philippians 1:10 That ye may approve things that are excellent; that ye may be sincere and without offence till the day of Christ;

Be cautious of giving.

Psalms 73:15 If I say, I will speak thus; behold, I should offend against the generation of thy children.

Romans 14:13 Let us not therefore Judge one another any more: but Judge this rather, that no man put a stumblingblock or an occasion to fall in his brother's way.

1 Corinthians 8:9 But take heed lest by any means this liberty of yours become a stumblingblock to them that are weak.

Have a Conscience void of.

Acts 24:16 And herein do I exercise myself, to have always a Conscience void of offence toward God, and toward men.

Cut off what causes, to themselves.

Matthew 5:29-30 And if thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into Hell. 30 And if thy right hand offend thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into Hell.

Not let their liberty occasion, to others.

1 Corinthians 8:9 But take heed lest by any means this liberty of yours become a stumblingblock to them that are weak.

Use self-denial rather than occasion.

Romans 14:21 It is good neither to eat flesh, nor to drink wine, nor any thing whereby thy brother stumbleth, or is offended, or is made weak.

1 Corinthians 8:13 Wherefore, if meat make my brother to offend, I will eat no flesh while the world standeth, lest I make my brother to offend.

Avoid those who cause.

Romans 16:17 Now I Beseech you, Brethren, mark them which cause divisions and offences contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them.

Reprove those who cause.

Exodus 32:21 And Moses said unto Aaron, What did this people unto thee, that thou hast brought so great a Sin upon them?

1 Samuel 2:24 Nay, my sons; for it is no good report that I hear: ye make the LORDS' people to transgress.

MINISTERS SHOULD

Be cautious of giving.

2 Corinthians 6:3 Giving no offence in any thing, that the ministry be not blamed:

Remove that which causes.

Isaiah 57:14 And shall say, Cast ye up, cast ye up, prepare the way, take up the stumblingblock out of the way of my people.

All things that cause, shall be gathered out of Christ's kingdom.

Matthew 13:41 The Son of man shall send forth his Angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all things that offend, and them which do iniquity;

Denunciation against those who cause.

Matthew 18:7 Woe unto the world because of offences! for it must needs be that offences come; but woe to that man by whom the offence cometh!

Mark 9:42 And whosoever shall offend one of these little ones that believe in me, it is better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and he were cast into the sea.

Punishment for occasioning.

Ezekiel 44:12 Because they ministered unto them before their Idols, and caused the house of Israel to fall into iniquity; therefore have I lifted up mine hand against them, saith the Lord GOD, and they shall bear their iniquity.

Malachi 2:8-9 But ye are departed out of the way; ye have caused many to stumble at The Law; ye have corrupted the covenant of Levi, saith the LORD of hosts. 9 Therefore have I also made you contemptible and base before all the people, according as ye have not kept my ways, but have been partial in The Law.

Exemplified.

Aaron,

Exodus 32:2-6 And Aaron said unto them, Break off the golden earrings, which are in the ears of your wives, of your sons, and of your daughters, and bring them unto me. 3 And all the people brake off the golden earrings which were in their ears, and brought them unto Aaron. 4 And he received them at their hand, and fashioned it with a graving tool, after he had made it a molten calf: and they said, These be thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt. 5 And when Aaron saw it, he built an altar before it; and Aaron made proclamation, and said, To morrow is a feast to the LORD. ...

Balaam, ect.

Numbers 31:16 Behold, these caused the children of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to commit trespass against the LORD in the matter of Peor, and there was a plague among the Congregation of the LORD.

Revelation 2:14 But I have a few things against thee, because thou hast there them that hold the doctrine of Balaam, who taught Balac to cast a stumblingblock before the children of Israel, to eat things sacrificed unto Idols, and to commit Fornication.

Gideon,

Judges 8:27 And Gideon made an ephod thereof, and put it in his city, even in Ophrah: and all Israel went thither a whoring after it: which thing became a snare unto Gideon, and to his house.

Sons of Eli,

1 Samuel 2:12-17 Now the sons of Eli were sons of Belial; they knew not the LORD. 13 And the priests' custom with the people was, that, when any man offered sacrifice, the priest's Servant came, while the flesh was in seething, with a fleshhook of three teeth in his hand; 14 And he struck it into the pan, or kettle, or Caldron, or pot; all that the fleshhook brought up the priest took for himself. So they did in Shiloh unto all the Israelites that came thither. 15 Also before they burnt the fat, the priest's Servant came, and said to the man that sacrificed, Give flesh to roast for the priest; for he will not have sodden flesh of thee, but raw. ...

Jeroboam,

1 Kings 12:26-30 And Jeroboam said in his heart, Now shall the kingdom return to the house of David: 27 If this people go up to do sacrifice in the house of the LORD at Jerusalem, then shall the heart of this people turn again unto their lord, even unto Rehoboam king of Judah, and they shall kill me, and go again to Rehoboam king of Judah. 28 Whereupon the king took counsel, and made two calves of gold, and said unto them, It is too much for you to go up to Jerusalem: behold thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt. 29 And he set the one in Bethel, and the other put he in Dan. ...

Old Prophet,

1 Kings 13:18-26 He said unto him, I am a prophet also as thou Art; and an angel

spake unto me by the word of the LORD, saying, Bring him back with thee into thine house, that he may eat bread and drink water. But he lied unto him. 19 So he went back with him, and did eat bread in his house, and drank water. 20 And it came to pass, as they sat at the table, that the word of the LORD came unto the prophet that brought him back: 21 And he cried unto the man of God that came from Judah, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Forasmuch as thou hast disobeyed the mouth of the LORD, and hast not kept the commandment which the LORD thy God commanded thee, ...

Priests,

Malachi 2:8 But ye are departed out of the way; ye have caused many to stumble at The Law; ye have corrupted the covenant of Levi, saith the LORD of hosts.

Peter,

Matthew 16:23 But he turned, and said unto Peter, Get thee behind me, Satan: thou Art an offence unto me: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but those that be of men.